

What ties all of us together when we *Choose FI* is that we become clear on what we want and then align our lives and finances to work toward achieving what we value. A term has grown out of the *ChooseFI* podcast to encompass all of us pursuing FI: “valuist.” A valulist is someone who spends their time and money consistently with their values. You do not have to adopt anyone else’s definition of success or failure, but to gain traction on the path to FI you do have to determine what you value and then start spending your time and money accordingly.

People who *Choose FI* can seem strange to those who don’t understand the concept of a valulist. Jonathan originally learned of Brad when he heard him on another podcast talking about approaching FI in his thirties. Brad also discussed using credit card travel rewards to take a trip with his wife, kids, and all four grandparents to Disney World. Jonathan was surprised the first few times he met up with Brad in person. Brad always wore flip-flops, shorts, and one of his assorted free t-shirts from FinCon, a conference for financial bloggers. Brad values travel and time with family, so he devotes time and money to those ends. He doesn’t value fancy clothes, so he doesn’t spend time and money trying to impress others with his wardrobe. He’s a valulist.